

Global Memory Tech

Weekly theme: post J-curve cycle, Micron vs Samsung/Hynix, strong exports

Industry Overview

Moving beyond J-curve, with no hard landing

We believe the memory cycle will move beyond the J-shaped phase of sequential growth as of 4Q26. This is consistent with Micron's recent results and new guidance: sales rose 31% QoQ in the Aug'26 quarter, vs 74% in the May'26 quarter, and are guided to rise only 13.5% in the Nov'26 quarter. This trend may be used for the bearish thesis (memory sector), but fundamental upside remains high for three reasons: 1) high margins – Micron guided to an 86% gross margin for the Nov'26 quarter despite sharply lower QoQ sales growth and rising employee incentives; 2) low P/E multiples – just 5-7x for most memory stocks, even on 2028E EPS; and 3) record-high buybacks or cash dividends. Like Asian memory chipmakers, Micron appears to believe that the memory shortage could become more severe through 2027 (vs new chip demand), despite additional fabs coming online across Asia and the US. Net-net, growth deceleration should not be a concern as long as sales/OP at 10x the levels of the 2018/21 upturns prove sustainable, as indicated by Micron's results and guidance.

Similarities and differences: Micron vs Samsung/Hynix

We also learned that Micron's six strategies broadly align with those of Samsung Electronics and SK Hynix: 1) active shareholder returns; 2) increasing LTAs with a more diversified customer base, including Big Tech and OEMs; 3) new fab construction but limited wafer-capacity expansion because of longer manufacturing cycle times; 4) chip supply that remains insufficient relative to long-term demand; 5) stable ASPs, with top-line growth driven more by volume than by aggressive DRAM/NAND price increases; 6) and a strong commitment to HBM, with significant capacity expansion vs conventional DRAM and more notable ASP increases for 2027 annual contracts. That said, earnings results and outlooks still differ by company: 3Q DRAM ASP QoQ (Samsung/Hynix: likely up 23-25% vs Micron: up high-teens); 3Q NAND ASP QoQ (Samsung/Hynix: up 15-18% vs Micron: ~30%); payout ratio (Samsung: 50% of FCF so far; Hynix: 50%+; Micron: 100% once a certain target cash holding is achieved in the Nov'26 quarter vs US\$75bn in the Aug'26 quarter); the LTA share of long-term sales through 2030 (Samsung: 60-70%; Hynix: 50%+; Micron: 35%+); and 1c (gamma) node migration (Samsung: not yet for DDR5 – still HBM4-centric; Hynix: already mainstream for high-end DDR5; Micron: clearly stated as its largest production node).

Strong Sept exports on HBM, DDR5, and rush orders

Korea's semis exports rose sharply in Sept (+29% MoM/+263% YoY). We see three drivers: 1) the successful HBM4 ramp-up, accounting for 50%+ of total HBM sales; 2) a 20-30%+ rise QoQ in DDR5 prices despite rising LTAs; and 3) quarter-end rush orders, incl. eSSD/NAND. Aggregating July, Aug, and Sept exports also point to robust 3Q growth of 30% QoQ, broadly in line with our 3Q memory revenue estimates for Hynix (+32%) and Samsung (+27%). Samsung's 3Q preliminary OP – our estimate is W107tn – is due on 8 Oct and could readily meet the Street's bullish consensus of ~W110tn, supported by strong Sept sales and ASPs led by HBM4, DDR5, and even NAND. Spot prices remained broadly stable this week, with DDR5 slightly higher but DDR4 and NAND lower.

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Refer to important disclosures on page 13 to 15. Analyst Certification on page 11. 13023558

Timestamp: 01 October 2026 10:51AM EDT

01 October 2026

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Exhibit 1: DDR5 still rising but softened, DDR4 and NAND seen as of early Oct

Spot-market prices among DRAM and NAND

US\$	Current	WoW	QoQ	YoY
DRAM spot				
16Gb DDR5	57.9	1%	24%	655%
16Gb DDR4	83.7	-1%	12%	545%
8Gb DDR4	46.3	1%	28%	628%
4Gb DDR3	13.7	0%	13%	483%
NAND spot				
1Tb wafer	30.6	-1%	26%	448%
512Gb wafer	19.4	-2%	-2%	521%
256Gb wafer	17.9	0%	76%	928%

Source: DRAMeXchange

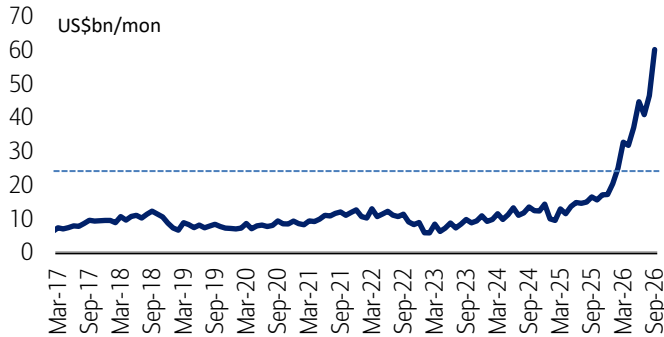
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ASP: Average selling price
CPU: Central processing unit
DDR4/5: 4th/5th gen double-data rate DRAM
DRAM: Dynamic random-access memory
eSSD: Enterprise solid-state drive
HBM: High bandwidth memory
HBM4: 6th gen of HBM
LTA: Long-term agreement
NAND: Not-AND memory
OEMs: Original equipment manufacturers

Korea semis exports

Exhibit 2: Significant MoM growth in Sept (+29%), resulting in a new record-high in Sep (US\$60bn), which is around 4x higher than month-average in 2025; mostly driven by HBM4, DDR5 and rush order

Korea semis exports - US\$bn/month

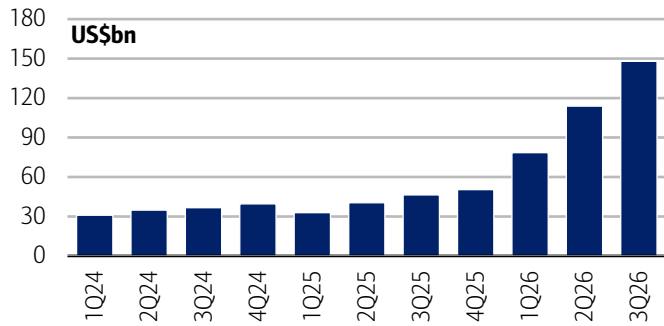


Source: MoTIR

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Exhibit 4: Record-high quarterly exports in 3Q26 (US\$148bn; +219% YoY), which is nearly ~3.5x higher than 2025-avg

Quarterly Korea semis exports

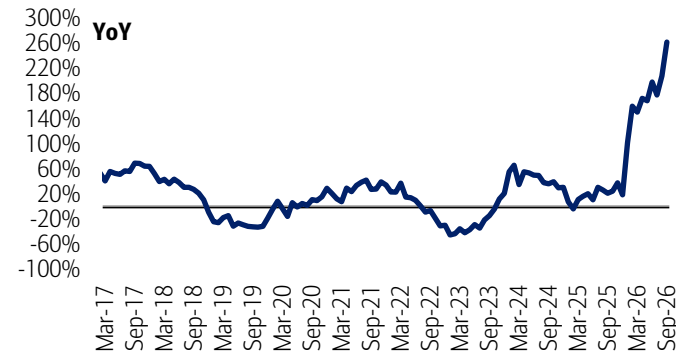


Source: MoTIR

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Exhibit 3: Robust YoY growth in Sept (+263%) and strong trend should likely continue throughout 4Q26

Korea semis exports - YoY change in monthly US\$bn

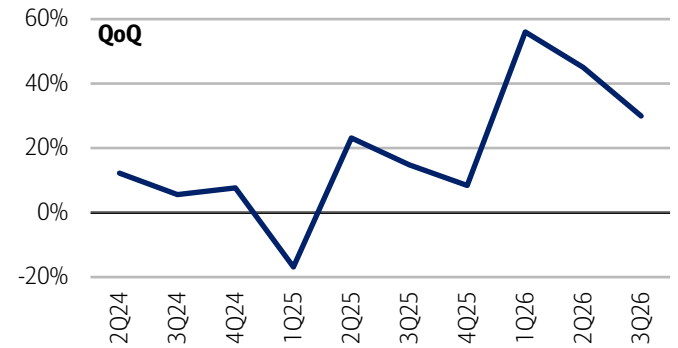


Source: MoTIR

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Exhibit 5: 3Q26 QoQ growth still resilient at +30% - in line with our 3Q memory forecasts for Samsung and Hynix (also up 30%+/- QoQ)

Quarterly Korea semis exports - QoQ growth



Source: MoTIR

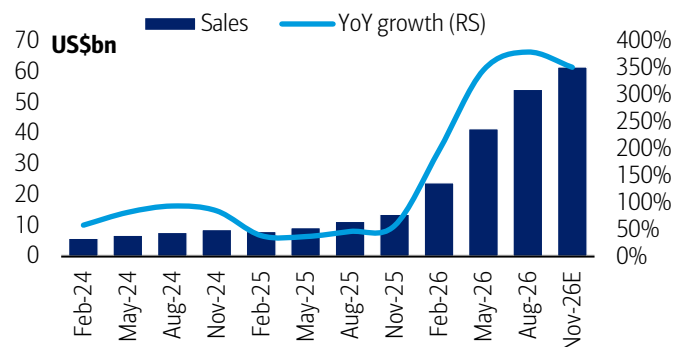
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Micron's FY4Q26 (Aug-Q) results

Exhibit 6: Stronger-than-expected Aug-Q sales (US\$54bn; up 31%/379% QoQ/YoY); Nov-Q sales guidance (US\$61.5bn) implies +13%/351% QoQ/YoY growth)

Micron – Quarterly sales and YoY growth

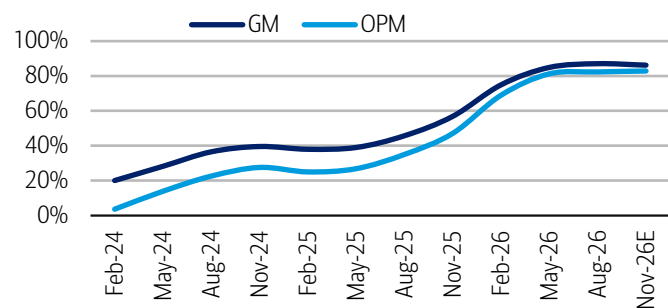


Source: Company, BofA Global Research estimates

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Exhibit 8: Record-high margins well-maintained in Aug-Q (GM 87%, OPM 82%); management indicated that GM in Nov-Q (86%) should be the floor in FY27 and expects higher GM throughout FY27

Micron – Gross margin and OP margin trend

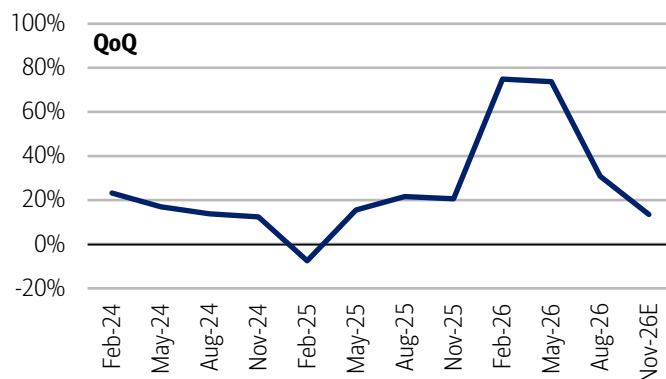


Source: Company, BofA Global Research estimates

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Exhibit 7: Sharp sales deceleration in terms of QoQ growth likely in 2H26 after steep hike in 1H26; but positive growth continues

Micron – Quarterly sales QoQ growth

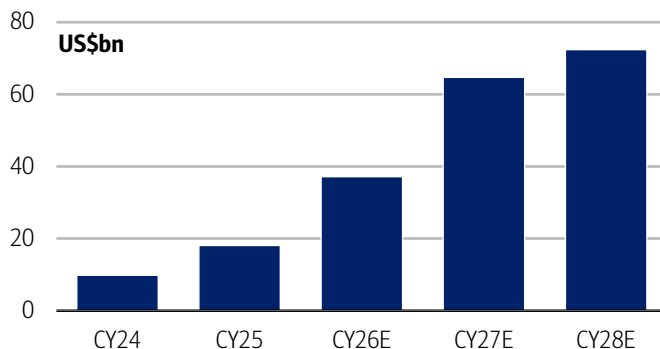


Source: Company, BofA Global Research estimates

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Exhibit 9: Near 2x higher capex in CY26 and annual capex of US\$60bn+ pa expected

Micron – Annual capex outlook

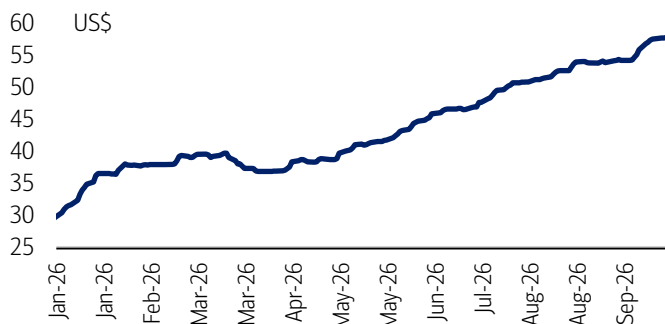


Source: Company, BofA Global Research estimates

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Key 6 memory price charts

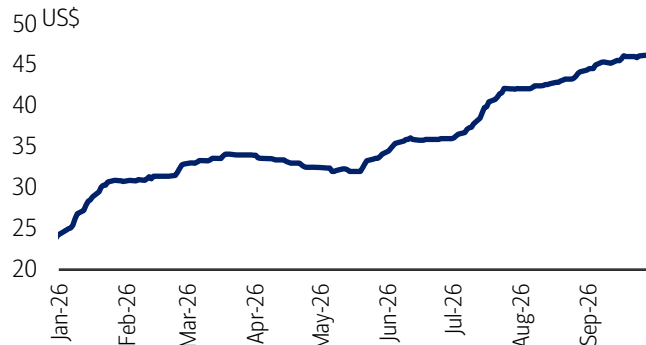
Exhibit 10: DDR5 spot prices slightly up this week to hit an all-time high of \$58, price overall up ~+100% YTD extending the 4Q25 rally
16Gb DDR5 spot price – daily, Jan '26 - Sep '26



Source: DRAmEXchange

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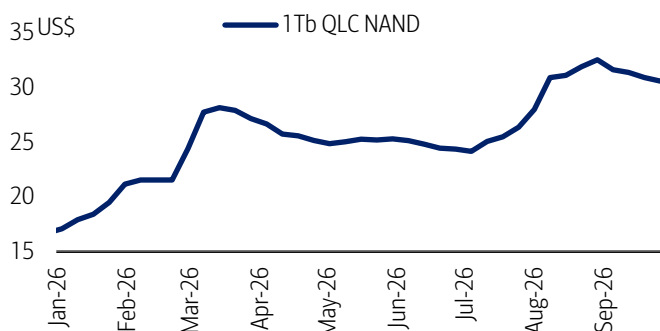
Exhibit 11: 8Gb DDR4 spot prices remained stable at around \$45, with no signs of a downturn yet
8Gb DDR4 spot price trend, Jan '26 - Sep '26



Source: DRAmEXchange

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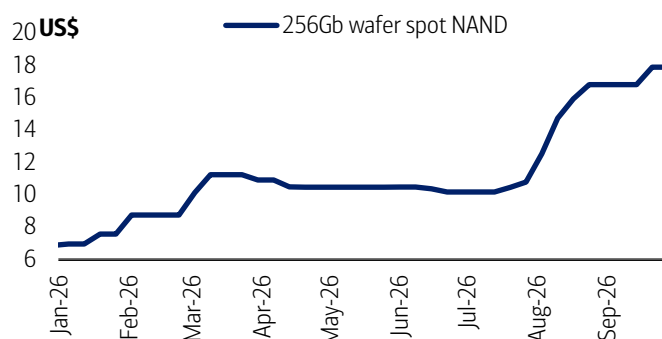
Exhibit 12: NAND spot prices softened through Sep after recovering from July through August.
1Tb NAND wafer spot price – weekly, Jan '26 - Sep '26



Source: DRAmEXchange

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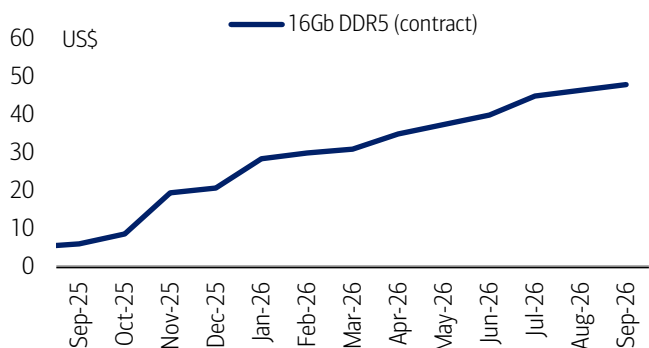
Exhibit 13: In contrast, low-density NAND wafer contract price rebounded sharply through Aug-Sep
256Gb NAND wafer spot price – weekly, Jan '26 - Sep '26



Source: DRAmEXchange

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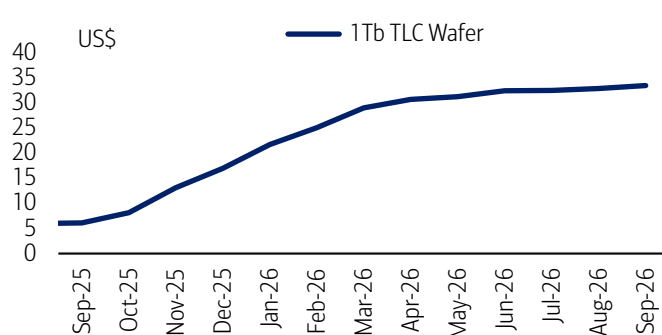
Exhibit 14: Sept contract price up further MoM (+3%); no sign for price cut even after 500%+ rally YoY
16Gb DDR5 contract price trend, Sep '25 - Sep '26



Source: TrendForce

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Exhibit 15: Sept contract price up (+2% MoM) despite muted spot or the sharp rally in 4Q25-1Q26
1Tb NAND wafer contract price trend, Sep '25 - Sep '26



Source: TrendForce

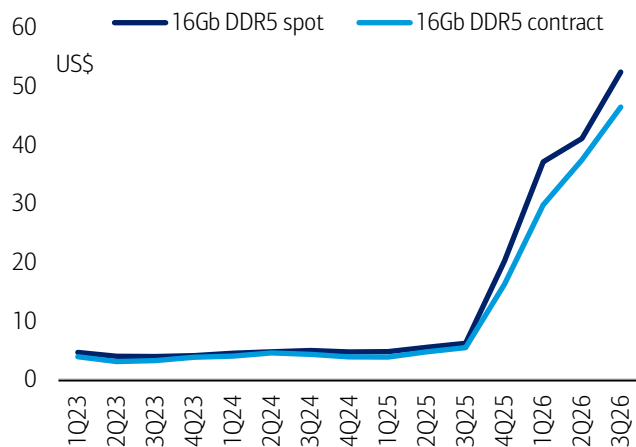
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Quarterly average price trend

Exhibit 16: DRAM spot and contract prices reached record highs of ~\$48–55, with gains moderating in 2Q–3Q26 after the sharp rally seen in 4Q25–1Q26.

DRAM spot and contract price - quarterly average trend

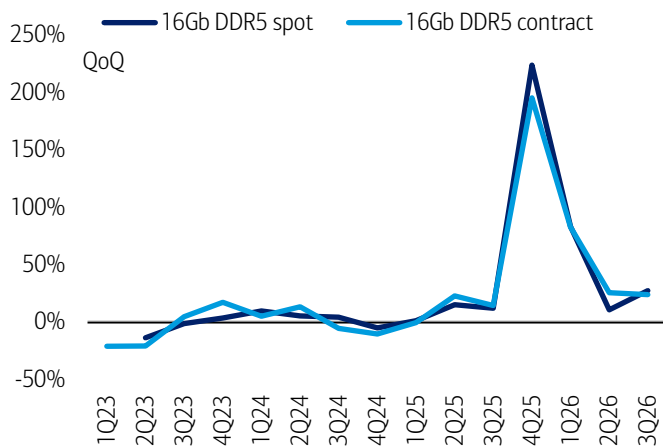


Source: DRAMeXchange, TrendForce

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Exhibit 18: Momentum remained positive at +20-30% QoQ in 3Q26, improving from 2Q26 levels but well below the exceptional rally seen in 4Q25–1Q26.

PC DRAM spot / contract prices (quarter-avg) – QoQ change

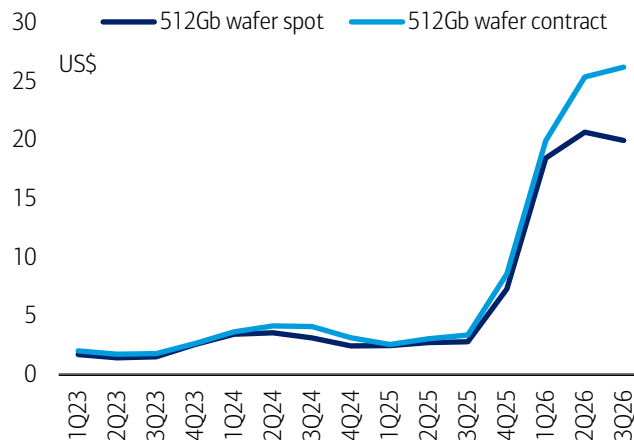


Source: TrendForce, DRAMeXchange, BofA Global Research

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Exhibit 17: NAND wafer contract prices have surged significantly ahead of spot prices, with now at record-high levels; spot slightly corrected

NAND wafer spot and contract price - quarterly average trend

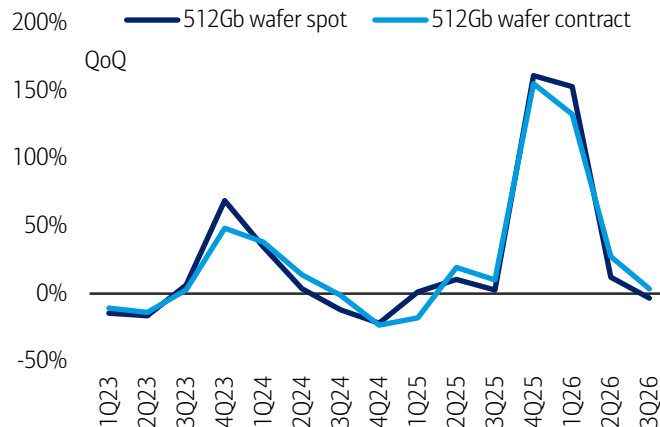


Source: DRAMeXchange, TrendForce

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Exhibit 19: Prices were broadly flat in 3Q26, versus +15-30% QoQ growth in 2Q26, following the sharp ~150% rallies seen in both 4Q25 and 1Q26.

NAND spot / contract prices (quarter-avg) – QoQ change



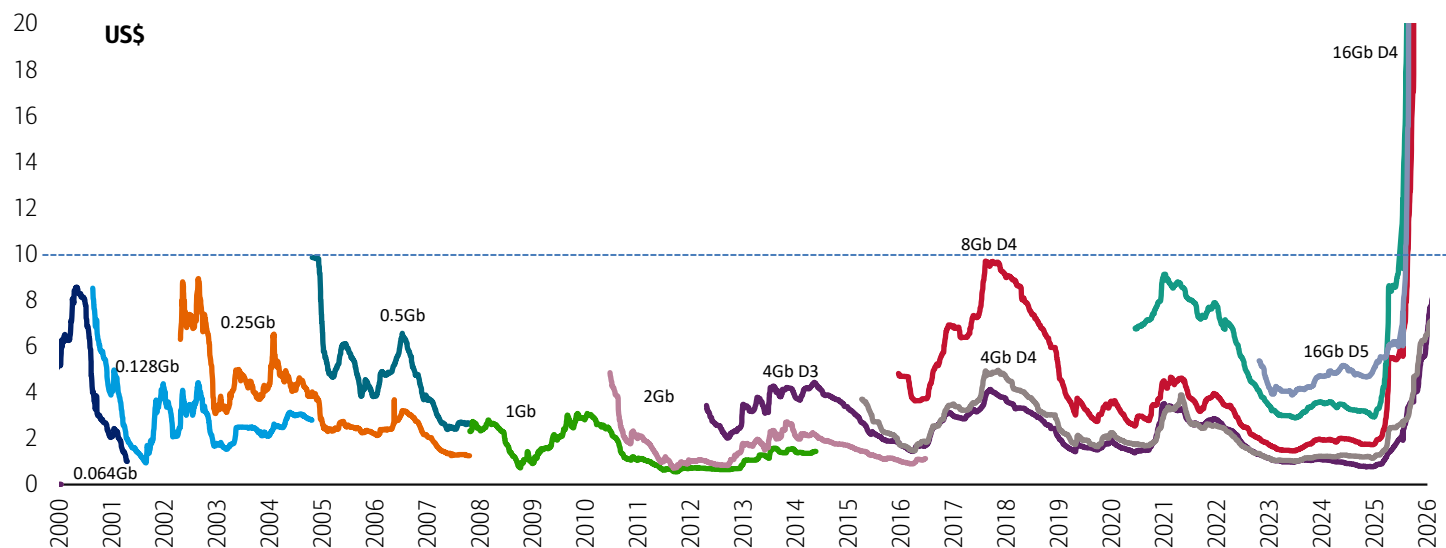
Source: TrendForce, DRAMeXchange, BofA Global Research

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Memory spot price long term trend

Exhibit 20: DRAM spot prices rebounded gradually through June/July/Aug/Sep, to hit all-time high levels. Prices have reached multi-decade highs, with 16Gb DDR5 (for PC) at ~\$58 and DDR4 at ~\$85, driven by supply reallocation toward HBM and server DRAM—well above the prior ~\$10 peak in Oct-17

DRAM spot price – long-term trend (2000-2026)

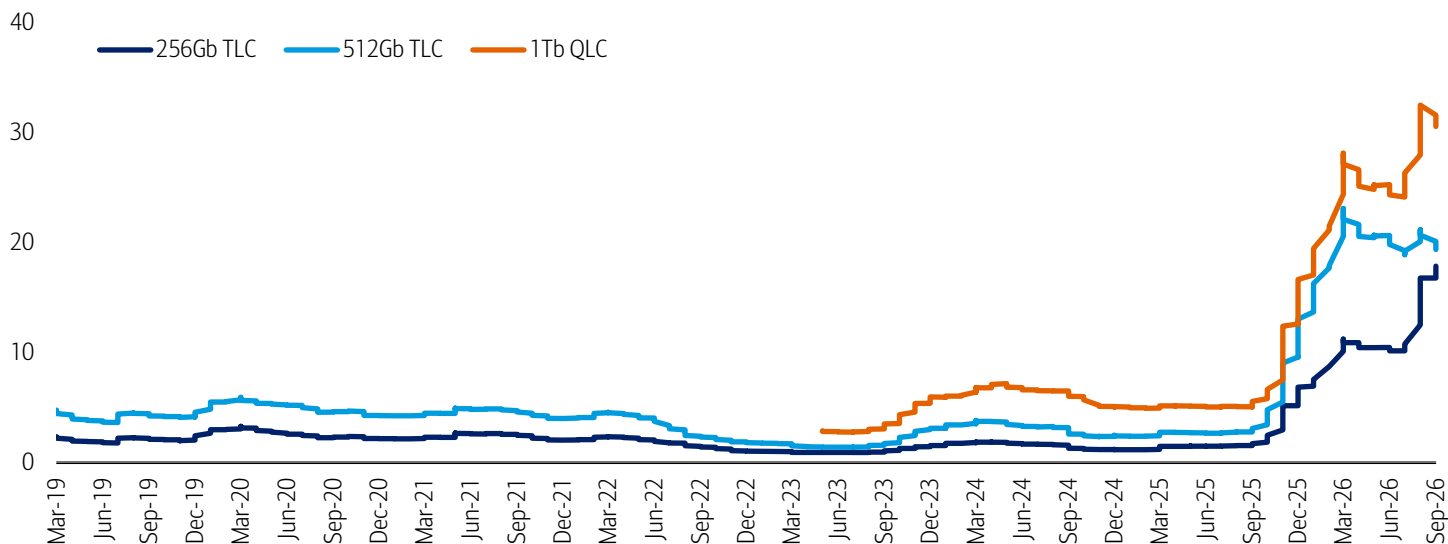


Source: DRAmExchange

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Exhibit 21: NAND wafer prices (512Gb and 1Tb) softened in September after a sharp August rebound; notably prices remained flat to slightly lower through 2Q26, following the exceptionally strong rally across 4Q25 and 1Q26. However, 256Gb NAND wafer price recovered in Sep-26

NAND wafer spot price – long-term trend (2019-2026)



Source: DRAmExchange

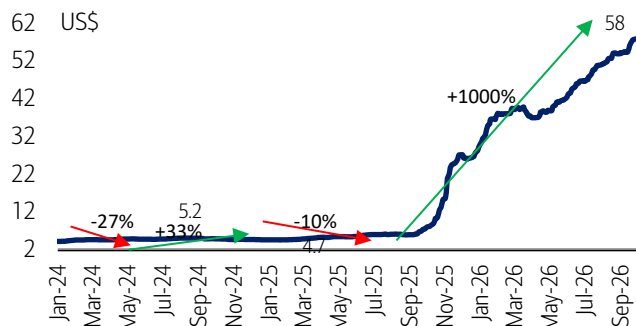
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DRAM spot and contract price trend

Exhibit 22: Price recovery extended from May through September, reaching a record high of \$58, driven by sharp gains in Oct (+70%), Nov (+60%), and Jan (+25%), before moderating during Feb-Apr.

16Gb DDR5 spot price – daily, Jan '24 - Sep '26

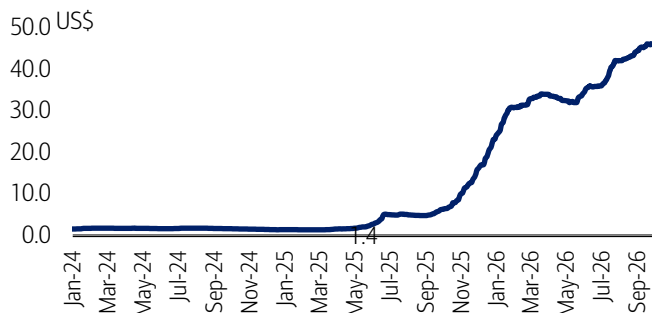


Source: DRAMeXchange

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Exhibit 24: 8Gb DDR4 spot prices stable at \$45 level, still well above the prior ~\$10 peak in October 2017, driven by ongoing supply cuts from major vendors

8Gb DDR4 spot price trend, Jan '24 - Sep '26

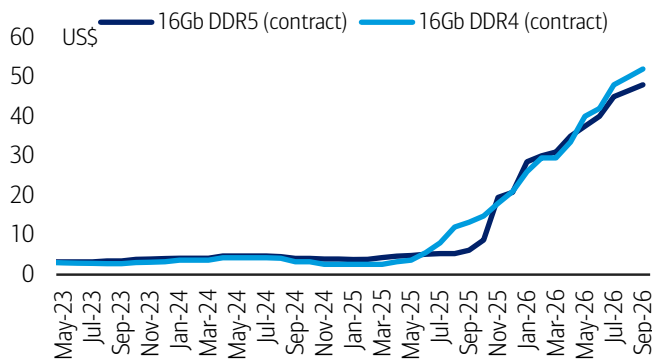


Source: DRAMeXchange

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Exhibit 26: DDR4 and DDR5 (16Gb) contract prices are similar at US\$50 level – DDR5 price premium no longer exists due to DDR4 shortage

16Gb DDR5 vs 16Gb DDR4 contract price trend, May '23- Sep '26

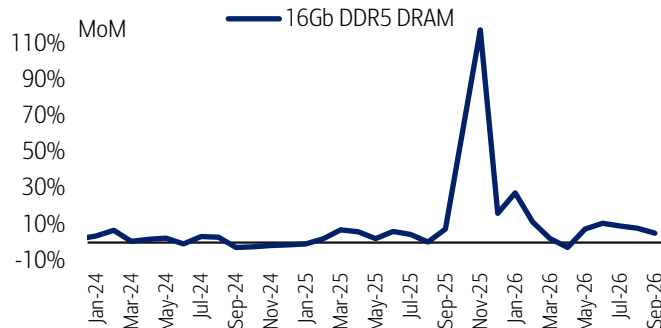


Source: TrendForce

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Exhibit 23: Still up in Sep (+5%) following a modest uptick observed through May/Jun/Jul/Aug (+7-10%)

16Gb DDR5 spot month-average price – MoM change, Jan '24 - Sep '26

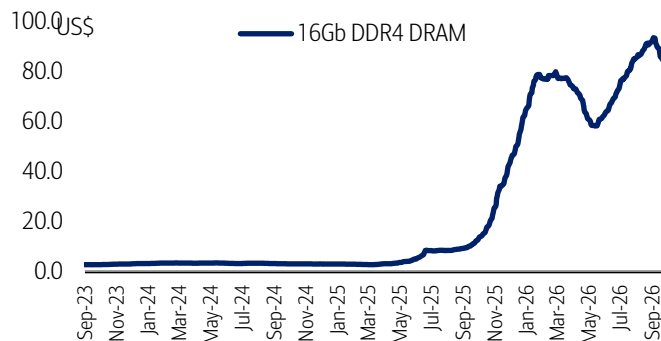


Source: DRAMeXchange

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Exhibit 25: Broadly flat in Sep, after rebounding to record highs during Jun-Aug following a ~25% correction from April-mid-May, price still ~2000% above the Oct-25 low (~\$3)

16Gb DDR4 spot price trend, Sep '23 - Sep '26

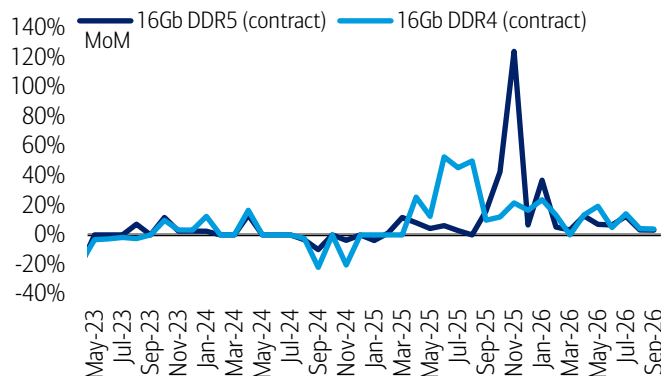


Source: DRAMeXchange

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Exhibit 27: DDR5 and DDR4 contract prices up only low-single in Aug/Sep vs +10-15% MoM in July; price strong through 2H25-1H26

16Gb DDR5 vs 16Gb DDR4 contract price change - MoM, May '23- Sep '26

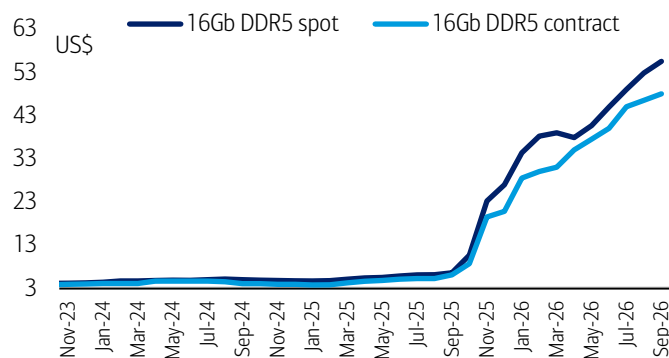


Source: TrendForce

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Exhibit 28: 16Gb DDR5 spot and contract prices are in the range of US\$50-55 vs historical range of US\$3-5

16Gb DDR5 spot vs contract price trend (US\$), Nov '23-Sep '26

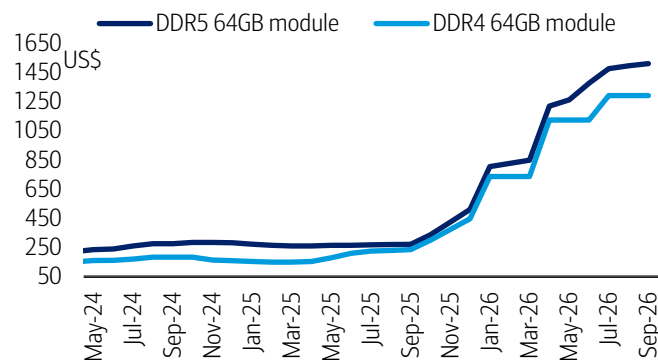


Source: DRAmExchange, TrendForce

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Exhibit 30: Current price of 64GB DDR4/DDR5 modules hit all-time high of more than US\$1,000 level (DDR5: US\$1,515, DDR4: US\$1,295)

Server DRAM contract price trend – DDR5 vs DDR4 modules, May'24-Sep'26

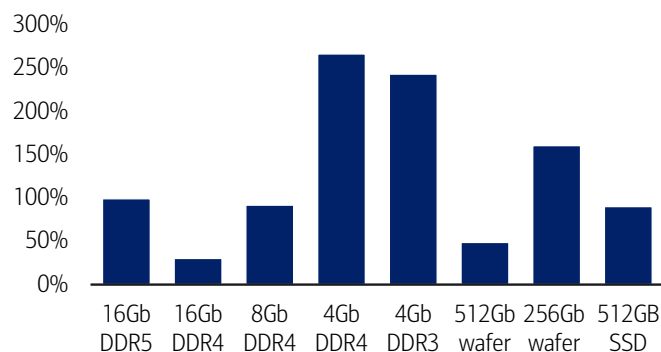


Source: TrendForce

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Exhibit 32: DRAM and NAND spot price overall up 100%+ YTD,

YTD change of DRAM and NAND spot price

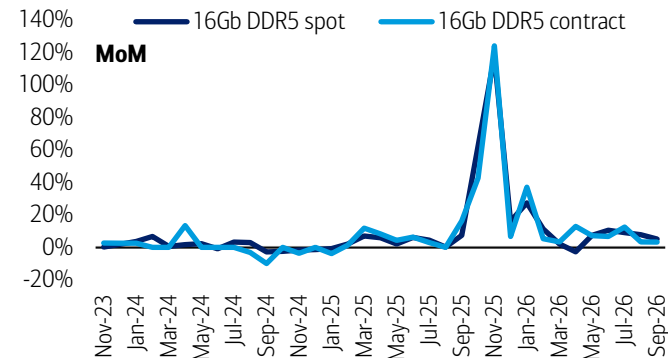


Source: DRAmExchange, TrendForce, BofA Global Research

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Exhibit 29: Sep price broadly flat following Jun-Aug recovery; prices had witnessed a sharp rally in Oct-Dec'25

16Gb DDR5 spot vs contract price trend – MoM change, Nov '23-Sep '26

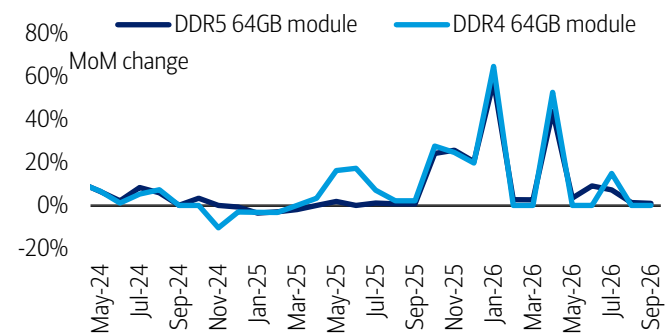


Source: DRAmExchange, TrendForce

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Exhibit 31: DDR5/DDR4 server contract prices remained broadly flat in Aug/Sep after recovering +7-15% MoM in July, remained stable in May/June'26

MoM change of server DRAM contract prices, May'24-Sep'26

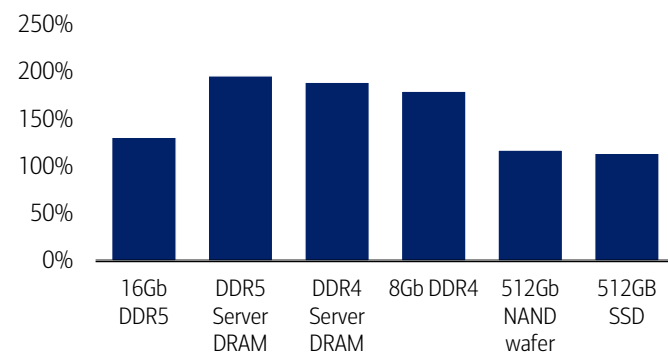


Source: TrendForce

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Exhibit 33: DRAM and NAND contract price overall up 100-200%YTD,

YTD change of DRAM and NAND contract price



Source: DRAmExchange, TrendForce, BofA Global Research

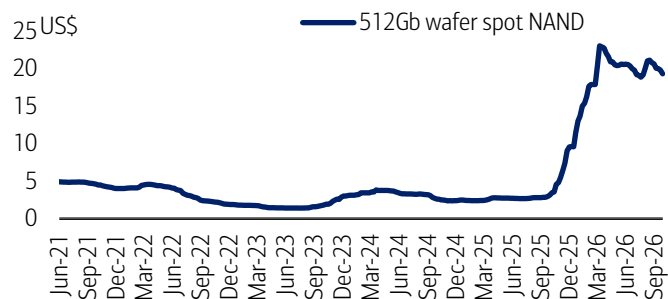
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NAND spot and contract price trend

Exhibit 34: NAND spot prices softened in Sept, following a sharp recovery in Aug; remained largely flat to slightly weaker through 2Q26 and most of July; prices are still up more than 50% YTD and nearly 8x above the February 2025 trough

512Gb NAND wafer spot price – weekly, Jun'21 - Sep'26

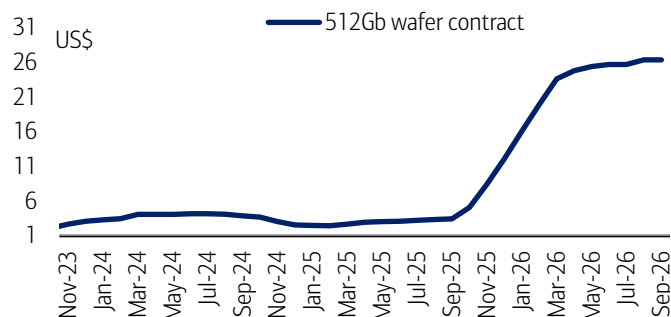


Source: DRAMeXchange

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Exhibit 36: Current contract price at ~\$27, around 10x vs Feb-25 bottom of \$2.5; prices significantly up in 4Q25/1H26 and remained broadly stable thereafter

NAND wafer contract price trend, Nov '23-Sep '26

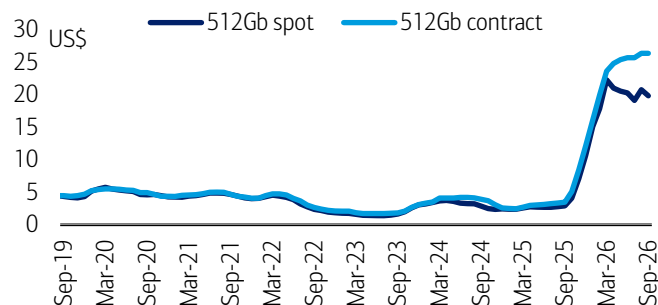


Source: TrendForce, DRAMeXchange, BofA Global Research

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Exhibit 38: Current NAND contract price still near record-high level vs modest correction for spot; that said, the contract prices are still a few times higher than 2025 summer level

512Gb NAND wafer spot vs contract price trend (US\$), Sep'19 - Sep'26

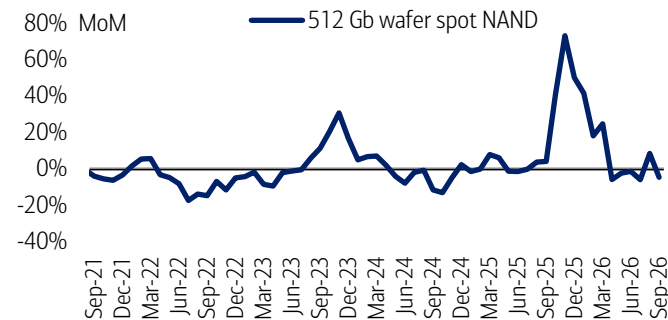


Source: DRAMeXchange, TrendForce

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Exhibit 35: Down in Sep (-4%) after a sharp recovery in Aug (+8%). Remained subdued through Apr-Jul (down 2-5%) following strong 4Q25 (+150%) and 1Q26 (+80%) rally.

512Gb NAND wafer spot average – MoM change, Sep'21 - Sep'26

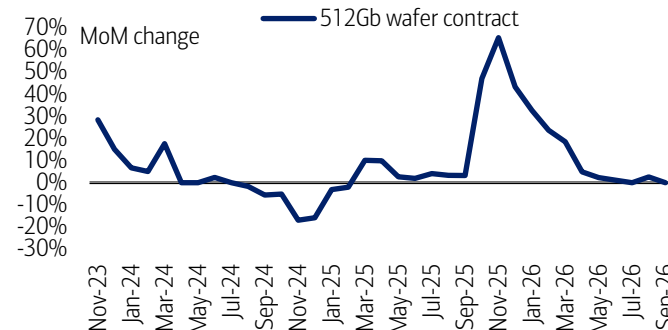


Source: DRAMeXchange

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Exhibit 37: Only low-single digit recovery observed through Apr-Sep following Jan/Feb/Mar'26 rally (up 20-30% MoM) and Oct/Nov/Dec upturn (up 40-60% MoM)

MoM change of NAND contract price (512Gb wafer), Nov '23-Sep '26

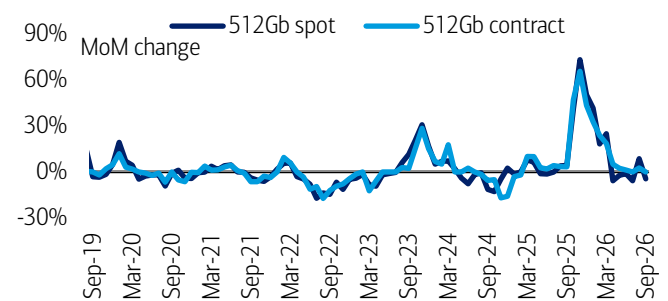


Source: DRAMeXchange, TrendForce, BofA Global Research

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Exhibit 39: NAND contract price flat in Sep vs spot fell 4% MoM post Aug recovery and normalizing in Apr-Jul; strong rally seen in Oct'25 – Dec'25 (up 40-50% per month) and Jan-Mar'26 (20-30% per month)

512Gb NAND spot vs contract price trend – MoM change, Sep'19 - Sep'26



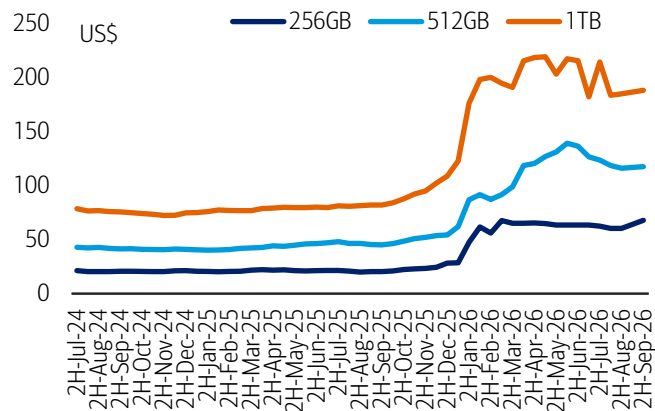
Source: DRAMeXchange, TrendForce

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SSD and panel price trend

Exhibit 40: Sep SSD prices slightly up vs Aug correction; strong rally witnessed in 1H26 following 2025 gradual recovery

Client SSD price trend – mostly for PC (not server), Jun '24 - Sep '26



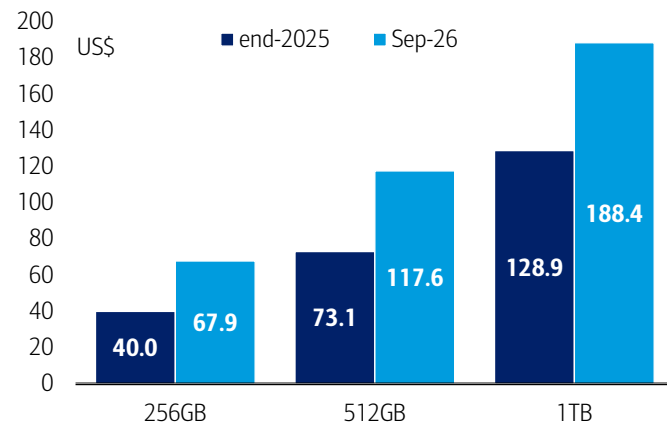
Note: SSD prices are as of 14 Sep 2026, reported by DRAMeXchange. TB = terabyte.

Source: DRAMeXchange

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Exhibit 41: Sep prices have more than doubled compared to end-2025 levels, while the 2025 increase was more modest at around 35–40%

Client SSD (for PC) price comparison – current vs. end-2025



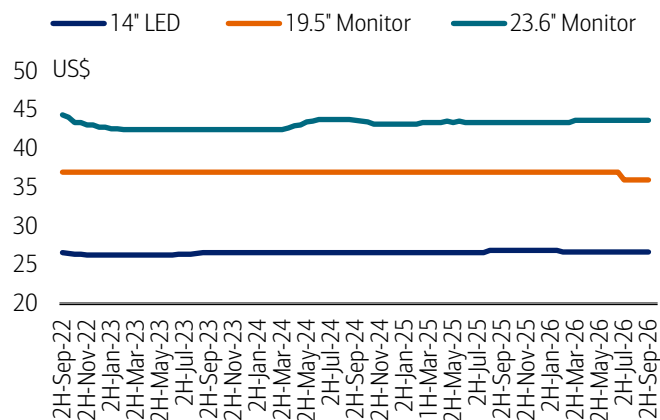
Note: SSD prices are as of 14 Sep 2026, reported by DRAMeXchange

Source: DRAMeXchange

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Exhibit 42: Broadly stable YTD – more China dominant supply vs minimal from Korea

LCD IT panel price trend – US\$/panel, Sep '22-Sep '26



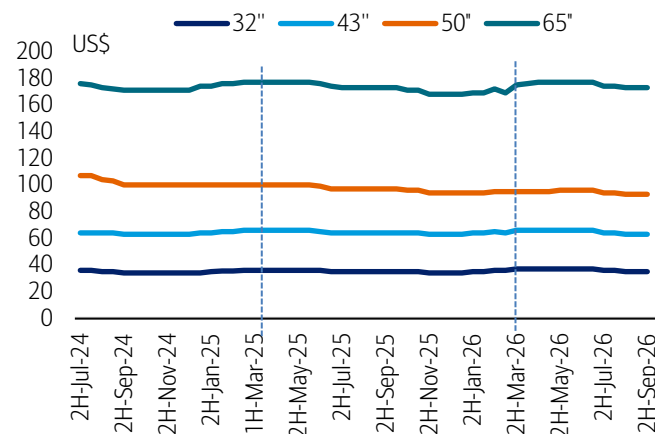
Note: Panel price update from WitsView as of 21 Aug 2026

Source: WitsView

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Exhibit 43: Prices slightly up through 1H26 vs slightly down in Jul-Aug and flat in Sep; prices remained broadly flat through 2025

LCD TV panel price trend – US\$/panel, Jul '24-Sep '26



Note: Panel price update from WitsView as of 21 Aug 2026

Source: WitsView

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Valuation and stock performance

Exhibit 44: Memory stocks broadly recovered throughout Aug-Sep following sharp correction in July. Fundamentals remain strong supported by robust HBM demand, and continued hyperscaler AI CapEx expansion; most DRAM stocks still trade just at 5-7x based on 2026/27 EPS

Valuation comparison among memory and semiconductor supply chain stocks

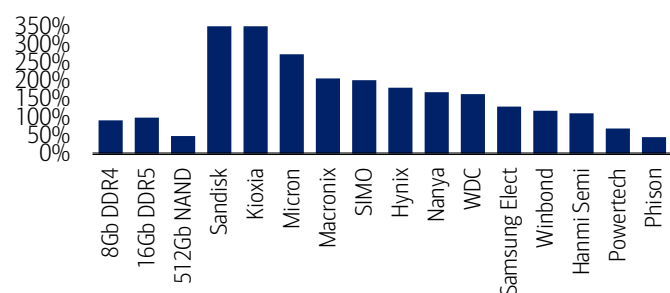
	Ticker	Rating	Price (Local)	Mcap (\$bn)	P/E			P/Book			EV/EBITDA		EV/Sales		ROE			Div. yield	
					FY26	FY27E	FY28E	FY26	FY27E	FY28E	FY27E	FY28E	FY27E	FY28E	FY26	FY27E	FY28E	FY27E	FY28E
Memory/DRAM																			
SK Hynix	HXSCF	C-1-7	1,776,000	989.3	5.1	4.9	4.9	3.3	2.2	1.6	3.1	3.0	2.5	2.3	98.2%	52.9%	38.1%	4.3%	5.3%
Samsung	SSNLF	C-1-7	268,500	1,192.1	6.2	4.8	4.9	2.7	1.9	1.4	3.0	3.0	1.9	1.8	52.4%	45.2%	32.5%	4.0%	4.1%
Micron	MU	C-1-7	1,065.11	1,202.9	14.1	6.2	5.4	8.7	4.4	3.0	4.8	4.3	4.0	3.5	89.7%	95.8%	68.8%	0.1%	0.1%
Nanya	NNYAF	B-1-7	519.00	56.3	7.4	5.4	6.7	3.7	2.4	2.0	3.2	4.0	2.5	2.5	72.7%	54.5%	33.1%	7.4%	7.5%
Memory/NAND																			
Kioxia	XIYUF	C-1-9	19,100	200.1	5.9	4.5	3.6	5.3	2.4	1.5	2.8	2.3	2.4	1.9	144.4%	74.2%	50.5%	0.0%	0.0%
Sandisk	SNDK	C-1-9	1,739.89	254.8	n/a	7.4	7.0	16.4	4.7	2.7	5.1	4.8	4.3	4.1	88.0%	103.2%	52.1%	0.0%	0.0%
Western Digital	WDC	C-1-7	454.46	156.6	n/a	23.7	14.3	18.8	10.9	6.3	15.9	10.5	8.9	6.0	54.9%	61.3%	58.5%	0.1%	0.1%
SIMO	SIMO	C-1-7	280.00	9.5	24.0	26.3	21.2	7.7	6.3	5.1	18.3	14.9	4.4	3.9	39.1%	27.2%	27.4%	1.0%	1.1%
Phison	PISNF	C-1-8	2,110.00	14.7	5.8	10.0	15.5	3.5	2.9	2.7	6.3	9.7	1.4	1.7	92.3%	37.0%	20.7%	5.5%	0.0%
US/Taiwan semis																			
NVIDIA	NVDA	C-1-7	228.38	5,504.0	25.1	14.5	9.9	19.1	10.8	6.8	12.4	8.8	8.3	5.9	96.8%	90.7%	77.6%	0.5%	0.6%
AMD	AMD	C-1-9	611.76	998.7	80.3	37.6	24.8	13.4	9.8	6.9	29.4	19.4	10.9	7.6	18.3%	31.0%	34.8%	0.0%	0.0%
Broadcom	AVGO	C-1-7	351.19	1,676.5	30.3	18.9	11.3	15.3	9.7	5.8	14.7	8.8	9.9	5.9	60.0%	65.1%	66.3%	0.8%	0.9%
Intel	INTC	C-1-9	120.23	635.4	81.8	59.8	41.2	4.8	4.5	4.0	21.2	16.6	8.4	7.2	5.9%	7.9%	10.6%	0.0%	0.0%
Arm	ARM	C-2-9	289.66	309.4	130.5	98.5	74.5	28.5	21.0	15.5	74.6	55.7	37.0	28.6	25.1%	25.0%	24.5%	0.0%	0.0%
Qualcomm	QCOM	C-3-7	184.04	193.2	17.5	17.4	14.8	6.7	6.3	5.4	14.0	12.2	4.6	4.1	44.4%	36.9%	38.0%	2.0%	2.0%
TSMC	TSMWF	B-1-7	2,510	2,045.0	22.8	16.1	13.4	8.3	5.7	4.2	10.8	9.1	8.0	6.8	43.0%	42.0%	36.1%	1.0%	1.0%
MediaTek	MDTKF	C-1-7	4,980	251.1	72.6	30.3	12.5	18.3	12.2	6.8	24.1	10.3	6.0	3.1	26.1%	48.1%	69.3%	2.7%	6.4%
Equipment																			
ASML	ASMLF	B-1-7	1,596.80	704.0	38.5	27.5	21.2	22.5	17.1	12.7	21.9	17.2	10.4	8.5	68.0%	70.3%	68.3%	0.9%	1.2%
AMAT	AMAT	C-1-7	511.38	405.8	40.1	27.6	21.8	14.4	10.1	7.3	23.5	18.8	8.7	7.3	41.9%	42.9%	38.2%	0.5%	0.5%
Lam	LRCX	C-1-7	328.51	411.1	56.4	35.6	27.9	32.9	18.0	13.1	28.9	23.9	11.9	9.7	65.7%	65.5%	54.0%	0.4%	0.4%
TEL	TOELF	C-1-7	12,580	187.4	7.3	5.3	4.2	2.2	1.8	1.4	3.4	2.7	1.3	1.0	33.6%	37.2%	38.1%	9.4%	12.0%
Hanmi Semi	HNSIF	C-1-7	256,500	18.9	75.8	42.4	24.1	26.1	17.4	11.0	31.5	17.7	17.3	10.4	39.4%	48.9%	55.7%	0.8%	1.2%
BESI	BESVF	C-1-7	191.80	17.7	41.3	26.2	17.4	19.5	15.1	11.5	20.7	13.8	10.5	7.5	61.7%	65.6%	75.9%	3.6%	5.1%
ASMPT	ASMVF	C-1-7	160.00	8.6	37.8	24.2	17.0	3.7	3.4	3.0	14.8	10.9	2.4	1.7	10.1%	14.7%	18.7%	1.7%	2.0%

Source: Company reports, BofA Global Research estimates; Mcap = market capitalization, ROE = return on equity, Div = dividend. Price as of latest close.

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Exhibit 45: Memory stocks were broadly up this week supported by stronger AI-driven DRAM/NAND pricing and HBM demand; current share prices are still far higher than end-2025 levels

Memory companies – 2026 YTD stock performance comparison



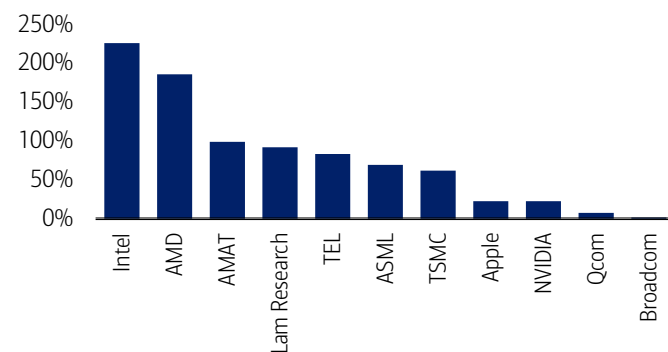
SanDisk and Kioxia shows above 400% YTD return

Source: Bloomberg, DRAmEXchange

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Exhibit 46: CPU names such as Intel and AMD outperforming other US big tech names such as NVIDIA/Apple/QCOM

Global major tech companies – 2026 YTD stock performance comparison



Source: Bloomberg

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We, Simon Woo, CFA and Matt Shin, hereby certify that the views each of us has expressed in this research report accurately reflect each of our respective personal views



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Investment rating	Total return expectation (within 12-month period of date of initial rating)	Ratings dispersion guidelines for coverage cluster ^{R1}
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Neutral	≥ 0%	≤ 30%
Underperform	N/A	≥ 20%

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